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Travel Radio Australia, we're here at the Arrival 360 event in Brisbane, Australia, and I'm here with Ian Salteri from Mates. Now Mates is not the way we say it in Australia, it's M-A-Y-T-E-S. Ian, welcome to the program.

Thanks for having me, great to be here. Now Ian, what is Mates? It's a great company, you're one of the chiefs there, or the chief, tell us all about it. I'm the founder and CEO of Mates.

We started Mates basically because we're a bunch of people that were sick of getting not paid back for group experiences, travel, a whole bunch of different things, so we decided to build a solution that can help solve that. Basically how our product works is that we integrate onto your online checkout similar to a buy now pay later service, but instead of splitting the costs four ways, like a buy now pay later does, we allow you to split the costs with your mates. So you can imagine I might be going on an experience, maybe the bridge climb or something like that with three or four friends, and instead of me being out of pocket for all of the four tickets, I just pay for my portion and my friends get links to pay for their portion of the tickets.

Dave, you could just sign up to the program M-A-Y-T-E-S dot co, C-O, yeah, and so it's a great system. How did that come about, was it your idea? Yeah, so we've actually been in the market for about three years now, but under a different brand name. Decided to pivot into, you know, B2B online checkouts, mainly because this is where we saw the problem happening a lot.

We are those people that are the group organizers, we're the ones that are always out of pocket or always chasing our mates to pay us back for things, and we just thought there must be a better way of doing it. So, you know, after about three years of operating a B2C app, the pivot and now we're mates, selling to B2B businesses. Well, this would be great for people going on lads trips or hens parties and things like that.

You must have a lot of those kind of clients. So we're actually relatively new, so although I've been building this for about eight months, we're only about six weeks or seven weeks old now with the brand, but you're exactly right, those are the clients that we're speaking to. Ticketing companies, travel companies, experiences, which is, you know, why we're at arrival this weekend.

So yeah, anywhere that you'd expect to split a cost with someone is where we are and where we hope to be in the future. And what's your background? And I suppose you come from a travel industry background? No, I don't actually. I'm the entrepreneurial side, so not even the technical side.

So I'm lucky enough to be surrounded by a great bunch of engineers and colleagues, but travel has always been a really big passion of mine. I've been lucky enough to see some really great places. And speaking of that, I always ask three of your most interesting recent places or in

history that you've traveled.

Number one for me, I've been lucky enough to go to Antarctica twice, but the most unique one version of that was we actually went south from Tasmania and went and did the Ross Sea. And we actually broke the record for the most southern navigation that a ship has ever been across the Ross ice shelf, which is really interesting at the time. I've also been to Iceland and the Faroe Islands, which was unbelievable and I can highly recommend.

It's a little bit easier to get to Iceland and the Faroe Islands than it is to Antarctica, but I can highly recommend going there. And third one, I'm a massive skier, so the European Alps. God, it's hard to pick one, but let's go to St. Anton.

It's an amazing place, an amazing Austrian town and just a great atmosphere and great skiing. Yes, it is a wonderful place. And I actually lived in St. Anton for about three months and destroyed a lot of cells at the crazy kangaroo.

I'm sure you have to. Boosie as well. Yes, that's right.

Yes, it's a great place. And Europe is great for skiing because everything's so close. You've got maybe a thousand ski resorts just up the road from each.

Yeah. And being my background, my family's from Italy, from Milano. So, you know, we base ourselves out of there for a little bit and lucky enough to travel to the Italian, Swiss, French and Austrian Alps, obviously the views there, the scenery, the mountain scape.

It is just one of the most spectacular, raw places that you can ever experience. Yes, the Dolomites are just unbelievable. Yeah, I remember sitting up, you know, having a beer, having a lunch and looking out and just looking at the mountains.

And the only way I can describe it is like looking at the sharp edge of a saw. You know, it's just it's so pointed and so harsh. And you sit there and go, wow, you know, the world is a amazing place and we're lucky to be experiencing it.

Well, there are tougher environments to be in having a beer, looking at the Italian Alps, maybe at a rival in Brisbane might be one of them. Give us your website again for Mates. It's a wonderful concept and a great system.

Yeah, sure. So it's www.mates, M-A-Y-T-E-S dot co-C-O. Thank you very much, Ian Salteri from Mates.

It's a highly recommended website and from Tribal Radio Australia. And thanks for being with us. Thanks so much, Jeffrey.

Appreciate it.

